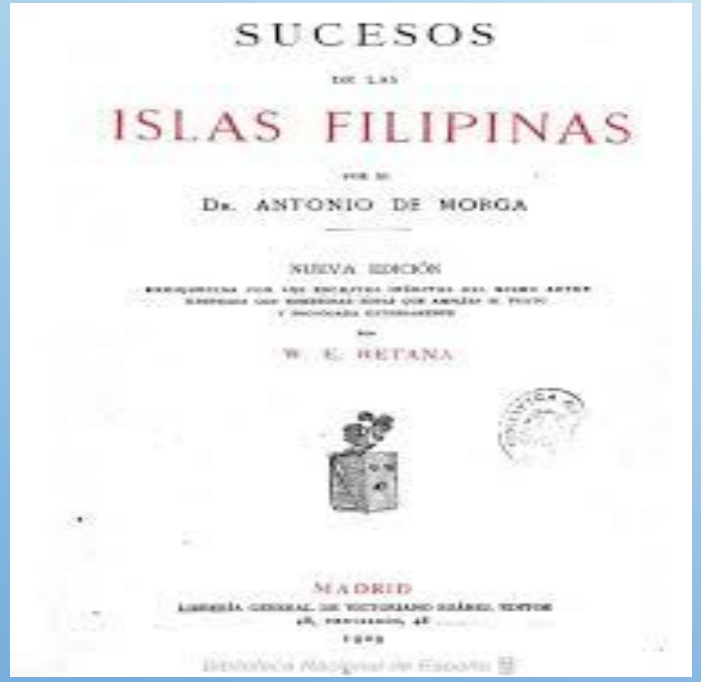


ANNOTATION OF ANTONIO MORGA'S *SUCESOS DE LAS ISLAS FILIPINAS*

DR. RINA RAMOS-PALMIANO JD,LPT

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- AT THE END OF THIS PRESENTATION, YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO:
- TRACE AND ANALYZE RIZAL'S IDEAS ON HOW TO REWRITE PHILIPPINE HISTORY.
- COMPARE AND CONTRAST RIZAL AND MORGA'S DIFFERENT VIEWS ABOUT FILIPINOS AND PHILIPPINE CULTURE.

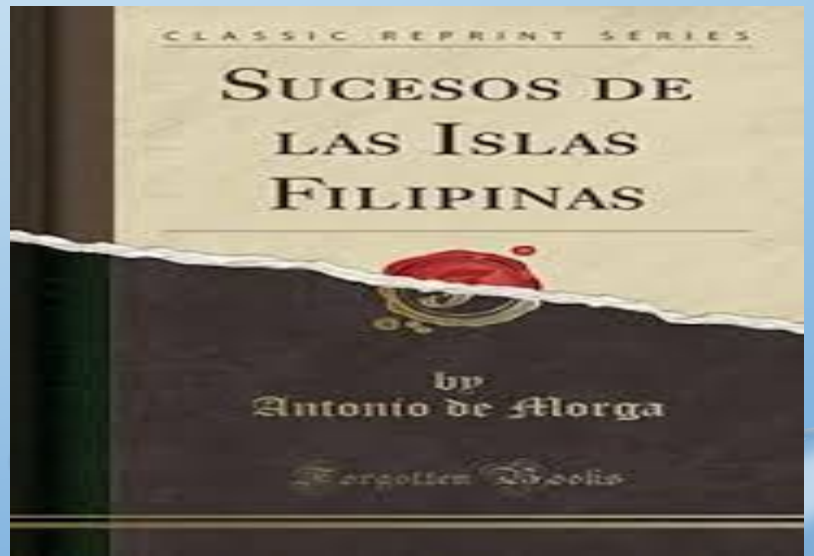
INTRODUCTION

SVCESOS DE LAS
ISLAS FILIPINAS.
DIRIGIDO
A DON CRISTOVAL GOMEZ DE
Sandoval y Rojas, Duque de Cea.
POR EL DOCTOR ANTONIO DE MORGA.
En casa de Geronymo Balli. Año 1609.

- **QUOTE:** "TO FORETELL THE DESTINY OF A NATION, IT IS NECESSARY TO OPEN THE BOOKS THAT TELL OF HER PAST."
  – DR. JOSE RIZAL
- **CONTEXT:**
- SPANISH SLURS AGAINST FILIPINOS PORTRAYED THEM AS LAZY AND UNCIVILIZED.
- RIZAL REFUTED THESE ACCUSATIONS, SHOWING THE FILIPINO PEOPLE'S RICH CULTURE BEFORE COLONIZATION.
- RIZAL AIMED TO RECTIFY ERRORS IN HOW PHILIPPINE HISTORY WAS PRESENTED BY ANNOTATING MORGA'S *SUCESOS DE LAS ISLAS FILIPINAS*.

THE NEED FOR HISTORICAL CORRECTION

- FRIARS WROTE BIASED ACCOUNTS THAT PAINTED NATIVE BELIEFS AND CULTURES NEGATIVELY.
- RIZAL SOUGHT TO DEBUNK MYTHS ABOUT THE "INDOLENCE" AND "BARBARISM" OF THE INDIOS.
- RIZAL AIMED TO SHOW THAT FILIPINOS HAD THRIVING INDUSTRIES BEFORE SPANISH COLONIZATION.



DISCOVERY OF MORGA'S *SUCESOS*

- DR. FERDINAND BLUMENTRITT INFORMED RIZAL OF MORGA'S *SUCESOS DE LAS ISLAS FILIPINAS* (1609).
- THE BOOK BECAME A KEY SOURCE FOR RIZAL IN RECONSTRUCTING PRE-HISPANIC PHILIPPINE SOCIETY.
- FIRST PUBLISHED IN THE PHILIPPINES IN 1958.

ANTONIO MORGA'S *SUCESOS DE LAS ISLAS FILIPINAS*

- WRITTEN BY ANTONIO DE MORGA, PUBLISHED IN 1609.
- FOCUSES ON POLITICAL, SOCIAL, AND ECONOMIC EVENTS DURING EARLY SPANISH COLONIZATION.
- *SUCESOS* PROVIDES AN INSIDE VIEW OF SPANISH ADMINISTRATION AND INTERACTION WITH FILIPINOS.

STRUCTURE OF THE *SUCESOS*

- EIGHT CHAPTERS, SEVEN OF WHICH FOCUS ON POLITICAL EVENTS UNDER THE FIRST ELEVEN GOVERNOR-GENERALS.
- THE EIGHTH CHAPTER, MOST RELEVANT TO RIZAL, DESCRIBES PRE-HISPANIC FILIPINOS AT THE TIME OF SPANISH CONTACT.

ANTONIO DE MORGA

- MORGA WAS A SPANISH LAWYER, GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL, AND ANTHROPOLOGIST.
- HIS *SUCESOS* WAS THE FIRST FORMAL HISTORY OF THE PHILIPPINE CONQUEST BY SPAIN.
- MORGA'S ACCOUNT IS CONSIDERED OBJECTIVE COMPARED TO WORKS WRITTEN BY FRIARS.

PURPOSE OF THE *SUCESOS* (ACCORDING TO MORGA)

- TO HIGHLIGHT THE DEEDS OF THE SPANIARDS DURING THE CONQUEST AND CONVERSION OF THE PHILIPPINES.
- DESCRIBES BOTH EXTERNAL EVENTS AND INTERNAL ADMINISTRATION FROM 1493 TO 1603.
- MORGA'S WORK SHED LIGHT ON PRE-COLONIAL PHILIPPINE SOCIETY, SHOWING ITS COMPLEXITY.

PRE-COLONIAL PHILIPPINES (ACCORDING TO MORGA)

- THE PHILIPPINES HAD A FUNCTIONING JUDICIAL AND LEGISLATIVE SYSTEM BEFORE THE SPANISH ARRIVAL.
- ARTS, LITERATURE, AND CULTURE FLOURISHED IN PRE-COLONIAL TIMES.
- BAYBAYIN, THE NATIVE SCRIPT, WAS SUPPRESSED BY SPANISH MISSIONARIES.

RIZAL'S INTEREST IN MORGA'S WORK

- RIZAL WANTED TO UNDERSTAND THE TRUE CONDITION OF THE PHILIPPINES WHEN THE SPANIARDS ARRIVED.
- BELIEVED FILIPINOS WERE SELF-SUFFICIENT, PROSPEROUS, AND HAD RICH TRADITIONS.
- RIZAL SAW THE SPANISH CONQUEST AS A CONTRIBUTOR TO THE DECLINE OF FILIPINO CULTURE.

RIZAL'S ANNOTATIONS

- RIZAL ANNOTATED *SUCESOS* TO CORRECT INACCURACIES AND EMPHASIZE FILIPINO ACHIEVEMENTS.
- HE SOUGHT TO SHOW THAT FILIPINOS WERE NOT PASSIVE VICTIMS BUT HAD A VIBRANT SOCIETY BEFORE COLONIZATION.
- HE HIGHLIGHTED HOW SPANISH COLONIZATION DISRUPTED THE PHILIPPINES' NATURAL PROGRESSION.

RIZAL'S PROCESS OF ANNOTATION

- SPENT FOUR MONTHS RESEARCHING AND WRITING ANNOTATIONS.
- PUBLISHED THE ANNOTATED VERSION IN PARIS IN JANUARY 1890.
- COLLABORATED WITH BLUMENTRITT, WHO WROTE THE PROLOGUE.

COMPARISON OF VIEWS – MORGA VS. RIZAL

- **ANTONIO MORGA:**
- DOCUMENTED SPANISH ACHIEVEMENTS AND FILIPINO SOCIETY FROM A COLONIAL PERSPECTIVE.

  JOSE RIZAL:
- ANNOTATED MORGA'S WORK TO HIGHLIGHT FILIPINO ACHIEVEMENTS AND COUNTER THE NEGATIVE PORTRAYAL BY THE SPANISH.

CONCLUSION

- RIZAL'S ANNOTATION OF MORGA'S *SUCESOS* WAS A KEY EFFORT IN REWRITING PHILIPPINE HISTORY FROM A NATIONALIST PERSPECTIVE.
- HIS WORK SHOWED THAT PRE-COLONIAL FILIPINOS HAD A COMPLEX, VIBRANT SOCIETY.
- THROUGH THESE ANNOTATIONS, RIZAL AIMED TO INSPIRE PRIDE AND CONSCIOUSNESS IN THE FILIPINO IDENTITY.

HERE ARE SOME OF THE IMPORTANT ANNOTATIONS MADE BY DR. JOSE RIZAL TO ANTONIO DE MORGA'S *SUCESOS DE LAS ISLAS FILIPINAS* REGARDING THE PHILIPPINES:

- **1. PRE-HISPANIC FILIPINO SOCIETY**
- **MORGA'S CLAIM:** MORGA DESCRIBES THE EARLY FILIPINOS AS UNCIVILIZED, LACKING IN CULTURE, AND PRIMARILY FOCUSED ON WAR.
- **RIZAL'S ANNOTATION:** RIZAL REFUTES THIS BY HIGHLIGHTING THE HIGHLY DEVELOPED SOCIETIES THAT EXISTED BEFORE SPANISH COLONIZATION. HE CITES THE FILIPINOS' THRIVING TRADE, AGRICULTURE, ARTS, AND COMPLEX SYSTEMS OF GOVERNANCE AND JUSTICE.
- **IMPORTANCE:** RIZAL CORRECTS THE SPANISH NARRATIVE THAT PORTRAYED THE NATIVES AS SAVAGES, ARGUING THAT FILIPINOS HAD A SOPHISTICATED AND PROSPEROUS CIVILIZATION BEFORE THE SPANISH ARRIVED.

2. BAYBAYIN SCRIPT AND LITERACY

- **MORGA'S CLAIM:** MORGA MENTIONS THAT THE SPANIARDS TAUGHT THE FILIPINOS HOW TO READ AND WRITE.
- **RIZAL'S ANNOTATION:** RIZAL EMPHASIZES THAT THE NATIVES ALREADY HAD THEIR OWN WRITING SYSTEM, CALLED *BAYBAYIN*, LONG BEFORE THE SPANISH COLONIZATION. HE ADDS THAT SPANISH COLONIZERS, IN FACT, WORKED TO SUPPRESS THE NATIVE SCRIPT.
- **IMPORTANCE:** RIZAL'S ANNOTATION RESTORES THE RECOGNITION OF THE FILIPINOS' PRE-EXISTING LITERACY, UNDERMINING THE COLONIAL NARRATIVE OF THE SPANIARDS "CIVILIZING" THE NATIVES.

3. PRE-HISPANIC FILIPINO INDUSTRY

- **MORGA'S CLAIM:** MORGA PRAISES THE INTRODUCTION OF EUROPEAN AGRICULTURAL PRODUCTS AND INDUSTRIAL TECHNIQUES.
- **RIZAL'S ANNOTATION:** RIZAL POINTS OUT THAT THE FILIPINOS WERE ALREADY INDUSTRIOUS, WITH ESTABLISHED INDUSTRIES SUCH AS BOAT-BUILDING, WEAVING, POTTERY, METALLURGY, AND AGRICULTURE. HE CRITICIZES HOW SPANISH COLONIZATION DISRUPTED THESE INDUSTRIES AND EXPLOITED FILIPINO LABOR.
- **IMPORTANCE:** THIS ANNOTATION HIGHLIGHTS THAT THE FILIPINOS WERE SELF-SUFFICIENT AND PRODUCTIVE BEFORE THE SPANIARDS IMPOSED THEIR COLONIAL RULE, DISPUTING THE IDEA THAT THE SPANISH BROUGHT PROGRESS.

4. ROLE OF WOMEN IN PRE-HISPANIC PHILIPPINES

- **MORGA'S CLAIM:** MORGA BRIEFLY MENTIONS FILIPINO WOMEN, WITHOUT MUCH EMPHASIS ON THEIR ROLE IN SOCIETY.
- **RIZAL'S ANNOTATION:** RIZAL STRESSES THE HIGH STATUS AND IMPORTANCE OF WOMEN IN PRE-COLONIAL FILIPINO SOCIETY, NOTING THAT WOMEN COULD OWN PROPERTY, INHERIT FAMILY WEALTH, AND EVEN LEAD COMMUNITIES.
- **IMPORTANCE:** RIZAL'S ANNOTATION EMPHASIZES GENDER EQUALITY IN PRE-COLONIAL FILIPINO SOCIETY, CONTRASTING IT WITH THE PATRIARCHAL VALUES INTRODUCED BY SPANISH COLONIZATION.

5. ON THE RELIGION OF EARLY FILIPINOS

- **MORGA'S CLAIM:** MORGA DESCRIBES FILIPINO RELIGIOUS PRACTICES AS SUPERSTITIOUS AND IDOLATROUS.
- **RIZAL'S ANNOTATION:** RIZAL DEFENDS THE NATIVE RELIGIONS, STATING THAT THESE WERE EXPRESSIONS OF SPIRITUALITY AND SHOULD NOT BE DISMISSED AS MERE SUPERSTITION. HE ALSO NOTES THAT THE SPANISH MISSIONARIES MISUNDERSTOOD AND DISRESPECTED FILIPINO RELIGIOUS PRACTICES.
- **IMPORTANCE:** THIS ANNOTATION SEEKS TO COUNTER THE COLONIAL DEPICTION OF FILIPINO RELIGIOUS PRACTICES AS INFERIOR, EMPHASIZING THAT THEIR RELIGIOUS BELIEFS WERE DEEPLY ROOTED AND SHOULD BE RESPECTED.

6. THE CONDITION OF THE FILIPINOS POST-COLONIZATION

- **MORGA'S CLAIM:** MORGA ATTRIBUTES PROGRESS IN THE PHILIPPINES TO SPANISH RULE.
- **RIZAL'S ANNOTATION:** RIZAL REFUTES THIS, NOTING THE DECLINE IN THE FILIPINOS' QUALITY OF LIFE AFTER COLONIZATION. HE OBSERVES THAT THE COLONIAL SYSTEM IMPOVERISHED FILIPINOS AND DIMINISHED THEIR ONCE VIBRANT CULTURE AND ECONOMY.
- **IMPORTANCE:** RIZAL'S ANNOTATION IS A CRITIQUE OF COLONIAL EXPLOITATION AND THE DESTRUCTIVE IMPACT OF SPANISH RULE ON THE FILIPINO PEOPLE.

7. ON SPANISH ATROCITIES

- **. ON SPANISH ATROCITIES**
- **MORGA'S CLAIM:** MORGA TENDS TO DOWNPLAY OR IGNORE THE VIOLENCE COMMITTED BY THE SPANISH AGAINST THE NATIVE POPULATION.
- **RIZAL'S ANNOTATION:** RIZAL BRINGS ATTENTION TO THE CRUELTY AND OPPRESSION OF THE SPANIARDS, DOCUMENTING INSTANCES OF EXPLOITATION, FORCED LABOR, AND ABUSE AGAINST FILIPINOS.
- **IMPORTANCE:** RIZAL WANTED TO EXPOSE THE REALITIES OF COLONIAL OPPRESSION AND CORRECT THE BIASED ACCOUNT THAT GLORIFIED SPANISH COLONIALISM.

8. THE CONCEPT OF FILIPINO IDENTITY

- **MORGA'S CLAIM:** MORGA REFERS TO THE NATIVES AS "INDIOS" AND VIEWS THEM THROUGH THE LENS OF A SPANISH COLONIALIST.
- **RIZAL'S ANNOTATION:** RIZAL REFRAMES MORGA'S OBSERVATIONS TO CELEBRATE THE NATIVE IDENTITY AND STRESSES THE DISTINCT CULTURE AND TRADITIONS OF FILIPINOS. HE OFTEN CORRECTS MORGA'S DISPARAGING REMARKS ABOUT THE FILIPINO PEOPLE.
- **IMPORTANCE:** RIZAL'S ANNOTATIONS PROMOTE A SENSE OF NATIONAL IDENTITY AND PRIDE, COUNTERACTING THE NARRATIVE OF FILIPINO INFERIORITY IMPOSED BY THE COLONIZERS.

LESSON II: RIZAL'S PURPOSE OF ANNOTATING MORGA'S WORK.

- **INTRODUCTION**
- **TEXT:**
  - "RIZAL'S *MORGA*, SAYS AMBETH OCAMPO, IS SIGNIFICANT BECAUSE WITH THIS EDITION, RIZAL BEGAN THE TASK OF WRITING THE FIRST PHILIPPINE HISTORY FROM THE VIEWPOINT OF A FILIPINO."
  - **KEY POINT:** RIZAL SAW THE IMPORTANCE OF THE PAST IN UNDERSTANDING THE PRESENT AND PREPARING FOR THE FUTURE.
- **IMAGE:** A SYMBOLIC IMAGE OF HISTORY (E.G., A BOOK, MAP OF THE PHILIPPINES)

RIZAL'S ASSERTION ON FILIPINO CULTURE

- **TEXT:**
  - "CITING DE MORGA, RIZAL ASSERTED THAT FILIPINO CULTURE WAS MUCH MORE REFINED THAN CLAIMED BY THE SPANIARDS."
  - **KEY POINT:** RIZAL HIGHLIGHTED PRE-COLONIAL FILIPINO ACHIEVEMENTS AND SOPHISTICATION.
- **IMAGE:** ARTWORK OR SYMBOLS OF PRE-HISPANIC FILIPINO SOCIETY (E.G., BAYBAYIN, TOOLS, ART)

IMPORTANCE OF RIZAL'S ANNOTATIONS

- **TITLE:** THE IMPORTANCE OF RIZAL'S ANNOTATION OF *MORGA*
- **KEY POINTS:**
  - **AWAKENING CONSCIOUSNESS**: RIZAL AIMED TO RAISE AWARENESS OF THE GRANDEUR OF THE FILIPINO PAST.
  - **HISTORICAL PRIDE**: HE WANTED FILIPINOS TO TAKE PRIDE IN THEIR RACE AND HERITAGE.
  - **CHALLENGING COLONIAL NARRATIVES**: RIZAL CORRECTED THE SPANISH PORTRAYAL OF FILIPINOS AS BACKWARD AND INFERIOR.
- **IMAGE:** A MAP OF THE PHILIPPINES WITH SYMBOLS OF PRE-COLONIAL AND COLONIAL ELEMENTS.

A HISTORICAL WORK FOR FILIPINOS

- **TEXT:**
  - RIZAL'S WORK WAS WRITTEN BY A FILIPINO, FOR FILIPINOS, ABOUT THEIR HISTORY.
  - **KEY POINT:** FOR THE FIRST TIME, HISTORY WAS PRESENTED FROM A NATIVE PERSPECTIVE.
  - **QUOTE:** "NO ONE HAS EVER WRITTEN THE HISTORY OF THE PHILIPPINES FROM THE PERSPECTIVE OF THE FILIPINOS UNTIL RIZAL UNDERTOOK TO WRITE IT."
- **IMAGE:** AN OPEN BOOK, SYMBOLIZING HISTORY BEING RECLAIMED.

AWAKENING CONSCIOUSNESS OF THE PAST

- **TEXT:**
  - **FIRST GOAL:** AWAKEN THE FILIPINOS' CONSCIOUSNESS OF THEIR PAST.
  - **SECOND GOAL:** ENCOURAGE FUTURE GENERATIONS TO STUDY AND HONOR THE PHILIPPINES' PAST AND FUTURE.
- **IMAGE:** A SUNRISE, SYMBOLIZING AWAKENING AND ENLIGHTENMENT.

PURPOSE OF THE ANNOTATION

- **TEXT:**
  - LAY BARE THE PAST TO BETTER UNDERSTAND THE PRESENT AND FUTURE.
  - PROVE THAT FILIPINOS HAD A CULTURE OF THEIR OWN PRIOR TO COLONIZATION.
  - **KEY POINT:** RIZAL'S WORK DEFENDED THE DIGNITY AND NOBILITY OF THE FILIPINO IDENTITY.
- **IMAGE:** A JUXTAPOSITION OF PRE-COLONIAL AND COLONIAL DEPICTIONS OF FILIPINO CULTURE.

MODERN RELEVANCE OF RIZAL'S *MORGA*

- **TEXT:**
  - **KEY POINT:** RIZAL'S *MORGA* SHOULD INSPIRE MODERN-DAY FILIPINOS TO LEARN THEIR HISTORY.
  - **QUOTE:** "NO TRUE CITIZEN CAN EVER HAVE TRUE CONCERN FOR HIS COUNTRY WITHOUT GOING BACK TO ITS HISTORY TO KNOW ITS STRUGGLES, FAILURES, AND TRIUMPHS."
  - **KEY MESSAGE:** HISTORY IS ESSENTIAL TO PRESERVING NATIONAL IDENTITY.
- **IMAGE:** A MODERN FILIPINO YOUTH WITH HISTORICAL SYMBOLS (E.G., FLAGS, HEROES).

CONCLUSION

- **TEXT:**
  - RIZAL'S ANNOTATIONS OF *MORGA* WERE TRANSFORMATIVE AND REVOLUTIONARY FOR FILIPINO IDENTITY.
  - **KEY QUOTE:** "LEARNING HISTORY SHOULD NOT ONLY BE INFORMATIVE, IT IS MEANT TO BE TRANSFORMATIVE." – AMBETH OCAMPO
- **IMAGE:** A PHILIPPINE FLAG INTERTWINED WITH SYMBOLS OF HISTORY (BOOKS, NATIONAL HEROES).

ACTIVITY 1 TITLE: "UNDERSTANDING RIZAL'S PERSPECTIVE ON PHILIPPINE HISTORY"

- **INSTRUCTIONS:**
- **READ** THE PROVIDED EXCERPTS FROM JOSE RIZAL'S ANNOTATIONS OF ANTONIO DE MORGA'S *SUCESOS DE LAS ISLAS FILIPINAS* (YOU CAN PROVIDE SPECIFIC ANNOTATED PARTS FOR THEM TO ANALYZE).
- **ANALYZE** THE EXCERPTS AND ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS IN ESSAY FORM (300–500 WORDS EACH).

QUESTIONS:

- **HISTORICAL INTERPRETATION:**
  - HOW DID RIZAL'S ANNOTATIONS CHANGE THE NARRATIVE ABOUT THE FILIPINOS AND THEIR CULTURE AS COMPARED TO MORGA'S ORIGINAL TEXT?
  - DISCUSS HOW RIZAL'S VERSION OF HISTORY DIFFERS FROM THE SPANISH COLONIAL NARRATIVE.
- **CULTURAL PRIDE:**
  - WHY DO YOU THINK RIZAL EMPHASIZED THE ADVANCED CIVILIZATION OF PRE-HISPANIC FILIPINOS?
  - HOW CAN THIS MESSAGE BE RELEVANT FOR TODAY'S GENERATION OF FILIPINOS?
- **MODERN RELEVANCE:**
  - BASED ON RIZAL'S PURPOSE IN ANNOTATING MORGA'S WORK, WHY IS IT IMPORTANT FOR FILIPINOS TODAY TO LEARN ABOUT THEIR COUNTRY'S HISTORY?
  - IN WHAT WAYS CAN LEARNING HISTORY SHAPE A PERSON'S SENSE OF IDENTITY AND NATIONAL PRIDE?
- **CREATIVE RESPONSE:**
  - IMAGINE YOU ARE A FILIPINO STUDENT LIVING DURING RIZAL'S TIME, AND YOU HAVE JUST READ HIS ANNOTATED VERSION OF MORGA'S *SUCESOS*. WRITE A LETTER TO RIZAL EXPLAINING HOW HIS WORK HAS IMPACTED YOUR UNDERSTANDING OF FILIPINO HISTORY AND IDENTITY.

CRITERIA FOR ASSESSMENT:

- **DEPTH OF ANALYSIS (40%):** THE STUDENT SHOULD DEMONSTRATE A CLEAR UNDERSTANDING OF RIZAL'S ANNOTATIONS AND THEIR IMPACT ON THE PERCEPTION OF FILIPINO HISTORY.
- **RELEVANCE AND REFLECTION (30%):** THE STUDENT SHOULD PROVIDE RELEVANT EXAMPLES AND REFLECT ON THE SIGNIFICANCE OF RIZAL'S WORK FOR BOTH PAST AND PRESENT GENERATIONS.
- **CREATIVITY AND EXPRESSION (20%):** THE CREATIVE RESPONSE (LETTER) SHOULD SHOW AN EMOTIONAL CONNECTION TO THE MATERIAL AND HISTORICAL INSIGHT.
- **CLARITY (10%):** THE STUDENT SHOULD WRITE CLEARLY